# 📚 Daily Editorial Vocabulary — Master List

**1448 words in 428 meaning-families** 11 new today. Near-synonyms share ONE row — the whole family, one meaning, one example, with the interchangeable words in (brackets) at the swap point.

**How to use:** read the example aloud swapping in each word of the family, then cover the meaning and recall it.

🆕 **Added today:** Acknowledgments, Administered, Artificial, Demonstrations, Distraction, Educational, Electricity, Exhibition, Jurisdictions, Pessimistic, Strategist

## 🧭 Contents


| # | Group | Families | Words |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken | 17 | 76 |
| 2 | 📈 Increase, Rise & Spread | 23 | 43 |
| 3 | 💭 Criticism & Condemnation | 9 | 57 |
| 4 | 👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen | 23 | 69 |
| 5 | 🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress | 12 | 64 |
| 6 | ⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder | 11 | 47 |
| 7 | 💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen | 3 | 12 |

| # | Group | Families | Words |
|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | 🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency | 22 | 48 |
| 9 | ❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt | 11 | 50 |
| 10 | 🌱 Beginnings, Change & Turning Points | 10 | 38 |
| 11 | 💰 Wealth, Money & Economy | 17 | 65 |
| 12 | 🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom | 10 | 34 |
| 13 | 🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims | 18 | 61 |
| 14 | ⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal | 10 | 31 |
| 15 | 🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards | 3 | 17 |
| 16 | 🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation | 7 | 47 |
| 17 | ⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority | 11 | 48 |
| 18 | 🌫️ Hidden, Unclear & Secret | 10 | 26 |
| 19 | 🧱 Real, Concrete & Practical | 2 | 3 |
| 20 | ✊ Reject, Revenge & Force | 3 | 21 |

| # | Group | Families | Words |
|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | ⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach | 9 | 32 |
| 22 | 🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception | 6 | 17 |
| 23 | 🚧 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks | 7 | 18 |
| 24 | 🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory | 4 | 28 |
| 25 | ⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth | 13 | 26 |
| 26 | 🌀 Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness | 7 | 14 |
| 27 | 👑 Power, Control & Influence | 2 | 8 |
| 28 | 😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity | 6 | 12 |
| 29 | 🌑 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant | 9 | 42 |
| 30 | 📦 Amount, Size & Plenty | 18 | 34 |
| 31 | ◻️ Difference, Comparison & Opposite | 3 | 4 |
| 32 | 🪤 Catch, Hold & Seize | 2 | 7 |
| 33 | 📌 Cause, Effect & Consequence | 7 | 33 |
| 34 | 🔺 Highest & Lowest Points | 2 | 4 |

| # | Group | Families | Words |
|---|---|---|---|
| 35 | 🗨️ Talkative, Loud & Wordy | 2 | 6 |
| 36 | 🤠 Boldness, Recklessness & Daring | 2 | 4 |
| 37 | 😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint | 4 | 8 |
| 38 | ▯ Unity, Sameness & Division | 3 | 5 |
| 39 | 🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour | 22 | 59 |
| 40 | Other & Mixed | 53 | 53 |
| 41 | 🧬 Word Roots, Prefixes & Latin Phrases | 8 | 74 |
| 42 | 🏛️ Polity, Government & Civics | 4 | 55 |
| 43 | 🔧 Science, Work & Industry | 3 | 48 |

## 📉 Decline, Fall & Weaken ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Abate, Ebb, Recede, Wane, Dwindle, Diminish** | verb | to gradually become less, smaller or weaker | *As the crisis passed, public anger began to (abate / ebb / recede / wane / dwindle / diminish).* |
| **Allay, Alleviate, Mitigate, Ease, Dampen** | verb | to make a fear, pain or problem less severe | *The package was meant to (allay / alleviate / mitigate /* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *ease / dampen) public anxiety.* |
| **Contraction, Deflation, Depreciation, Depression, Stagnation** | noun | an economic shrinking, fall or standstill | *Contraction = output shrinking; deflation = a general fall in prices; depreciation = a fall in the value of a currency or asset; depression = a very deep, long collapse; stagnation = a long period with no growth at all.* |
| **Curb, Curtail, Whittle, Attenuate** | verb | to deliberately cut back, limit or reduce something | *New rules were framed to (curb / curtail / attenuate) wasteful spending; the panel will whittle the list down to five names.* |
| **Decline** | verb | sense 1: to go down or decrease | *Enrolment has declined for the third year running.* |
| **Decline** | verb | sense 2: to politely refuse | *The minister declined to comment on the report.* |
| **Detachment** | noun | being emotionally distant; also a small group of troops sent on a separate task | *He described the tragedy with clinical detachment; a detachment of soldiers was sent to the border.* |
| **Deteriorate, Languish, Wither, Unravel** | verb | to get steadily worse or fall apart | *Without funding the scheme began to (deteriorate / wither / unravel); thousands languish in overcrowded jails.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Deteriorating, Stagnant, Downturn, Recession, Plateau, Diminishing returns, Devaluation, Deindustrialisation** | noun/adjective | getting worse, shrinking or losing momentum, especially in an economy. | *Output is (deteriorating / stagnant); the (downturn / recession) deepened, growth hit a plateau, and diminishing returns set in after the devaluation and deindustrialisation.* |
| **Erode, Undermine, Subvert, Cripple, Debilitate, Enervate** | verb | to weaken or damage something, often gradually or secretly | *Corruption has (eroded / undermined / subverted / crippled / debilitated / enervated) public trust in the institution. Note: subvert = weaken secretly to overthrow; cripple = damage severely.* |
| **Feeble, Fragile, Tenuous, Vulnerable** | adjective | weak, easily broken or easily harmed | *The ceasefire rests on a (feeble / fragile / tenuous) understanding; poor households are the most vulnerable to price shocks.* |
| **Flounder, Underprepared, Underestimate, Lopsided, Inequality, Inexperience, Maladroit, Unpopularity, Unfriendliest, Nominal, Disability** | noun/adjective/verb | falling short, being unfairly small, or failing to cope. | *The team (floundered / was underprepared); we (underestimate / undervalue) the gap; the lopsided deal deepened inequality, and his inexperience, maladroit handling and the resulting unpopularity made him the unfriendliest figure in the room,* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *with only nominal support.* |
| **Lethargy, Lassitude, Inertia, Malaise** | noun | a state of tiredness, sluggishness or unwillingness to act | *A deep (lethargy / lassitude / inertia / malaise) has settled over the bureaucracy. Note: inertia = resistance to change; malaise = a vague sense that something is unwell.* |
| **Mar, Dent, Flaw** | noun/verb | a fault that spoils something, or to spoil it | *The riots (marred / dented) the state's image; a single flaw in the design brought the bridge down.* |
| **Moribund, Inert, Languid, Lethargic, Tepid, Halfhearted, Perfunctory** | adjective | lacking energy, effort or life | *The response was (inert / languid / lethargic / tepid / halfhearted / perfunctory); the once-great mill is now moribund. Note: moribund = about to die out completely.* |
| **Plummet, Plunge, Slump, Lag** | verb | to fall fast, steeply or behind | *Exports (plummeted / plunged / slumped) after the ban; India continues to lag behind its neighbours on this index.* |
| **Resignation, Abdication** | noun | formally stepping down from a position or right. | *His (resignation / abdication) ended the crisis.* |

## 📈 Increase, Rise & Spread ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Accelerate, Facilitate, Facilitation, Encroach, Encroachment, Inundate, Contagious, Pandemic** | verb/noun | to grow, speed up, spread out or push into new ground. | *Reforms (accelerated / facilitated) growth; the (encroachment / spread) was rapid, cheap credit inundated the market, and the contagious optimism went pandemic.* |
| **circum** | root | root CIRCUM = around | *circumference, circumnavigate, circumspect.* |
| **cred** | root | root CRED = believe | *credit, credible, incredible, credentials.* |
| **dict** | root | root DICT = say, speak | *dictate, predict, contradict, verdict.* |
| **Disseminate, Diffuse** | verb | to spread something widely; *diffuse* also = to calm a tense situation | *The app (disseminated / diffused) weather alerts to millions; talks helped diffuse the tension.* |
| **Escalate, Soar, Surge, Proliferate, Wax** | verb | to rise, grow or spread quickly; *wax* = to increase gradually | *Prices (escalated / soared / surged) after the ban; misinformation proliferated online while the party's influence waxed.* |
| **Exodus** | noun | a large number of people leaving a place | *The lockdown triggered an exodus of migrant workers.* |
| **Germinate, Germinal** | verb/adjective | to begin to grow or develop, like a seed or an idea; *germinal* = at the earliest stage | *The idea germinated in a college seminar; the paper is the germinal work in the field.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hike** | verb | to raise a price or rate | *The bank hiked interest rates again.* |
| **Increasingly** | adverb | more and more over time | *Cities are increasingly reliant on tanker water.* |
| **Inflation** | noun | the general rise in prices over time | *Food inflation stayed above eight per cent.* |
| **magn** | root | root MAGN = great, large | *magnify, magnificent, magnitude, magnate.* |
| **Magnitude, Measure** | noun/verb | the size or scale of something; to find out that size | *No one grasped the magnitude of the loss; the study measured its true cost.* |
| **mal** | root | root MAL = bad | *malice, malevolent, malfunction, malign.* |
| **Marginalise** | verb | to push a group to the edges of society and ignore their needs | *The policy further marginalised landless labourers.* |
| **Overwhelming** | verb | engulf, surge over and submerge | *India's 'cockroach' protest continues a day after police crackdown Delhi witnessed overwhelming violence on Monday, with at least 60 protesters wounded.* |
| **Prevalence** | noun | how common or widespread something is | *The survey measured the prevalence of anaemia among children.* |
| **Rampant, Rife, Ubiquitous** | adjective | very common and spreading everywhere, usually of | *Corruption was (rampant / rife) in the department;* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | something bad; *ubiquitous* = present everywhere | *smartphones are now ubiquitous.* |
| **re-** | prefix | prefix RE- = again, back | *rewrite, return, rebuild, revise.* |
| **super-/sur-** | prefix | prefix SUPER-/SUR- = above, over | *superman, supervise, surplus, surface.* |
| **Surge, Hike, Expansion, Ascendancy** | noun | a sudden or sustained increase in level, price or power | *A (surge / hike) in fuel rates followed; the decade saw rapid expansion and the ascendancy of a new elite.* |
| **Sustainable, Holistic** | adjective | able to continue long-term; taking the whole into account rather than parts | *The plan is neither (sustainable / holistic) nor affordable.* |
| **Yield** | verb | to produce or give a result or amount | *The new seed yields twice as much per hectare.* |

## Criticism & Condemnation ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Admonish, Berate, Lambast, Lambaste, Harangue, Slam, Censure, Condemn, Deplore** | verb | to scold, attack or officially blame someone strongly; *censure* is the most formal, *admonish* the mildest | *The court (admonished / berated / lambasted / lambaste / slammed / censured / condemned / deplored) the delay; he (harangued) the crowd for an hour.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Castigate, Excoriate, Deride, Disparage, Vituperate** | verb | to attack someone with harsh words. Castigate, excoriate and vituperate are severe; deride and disparage are mocking or belittling. | *The court (castigated / excoriated / derided / disparaged / vituperated) the officials for the delay.* |
| **Culpable, Accountability, Onus, Obligation, Absolve, Exonerate, Vindicate** | adjective | to do with being blamed or cleared of blame; *culpable* = at fault, *absolve / exonerate / vindicate* are verbs = to clear someone | *Officials were found (culpable) and (accountability) followed; the (onus) and (obligation) lay with the ministry, but the inquiry later (absolved / exonerated / vindicated) the staff.* |
| **Denigrate, Vilify, Malign, Calumny, Invective, Obloquy, Opprobrium, Tirade** | noun | abusive speech, or the public disgrace it brings; *denigrate / vilify / malign* are verbs = to run down unfairly, *calumny* = a false damaging statement, *obloquy / opprobrium* = harsh public shaming | *The campaign was pure (calumny / invective / obloquy / opprobrium), a (tirade) meant to (denigrate / vilify / malign) a rival.* |
| **Ignominy, Humiliation, Affront, Accusation, Allegation, Defamation** | noun | public disgrace, or an act or charge that wounds pride and reputation. | *He suffered the (ignominy / humiliation / affront) of public dismissal; an (accusation / allegation) followed, and he sued for defamation.* |
| **Impudent, Brazen, Boorish, Surly,** | adjective | rude, ill-mannered or unpleasant in manner; *voluble* = | *His (impudent / brazen / boorish / surly / petulant) reply* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Petulant, Obtuse, Voluble** | | talking non-stop, *obtuse* = slow to understand | *showed him to be (obtuse); a (voluble) speaker filled the rest of the hour.* |
| **Lament, Bemoan, Contrite, Penitent** | verb | to express sorrow or regret; *contrite / penitent* are adjectives = feeling deep remorse for a wrong | *Leaders (lament / bemoan) the loss; the (contrite / penitent) official offered to resign.* |
| **Notorious, Reprehensible, Egregious, Flagrant, Glaring, Heinous, Iniquity** | adjective | openly and shockingly bad, deserving blame; *iniquity* is a noun = great wickedness or injustice | *A (notorious / reprehensible / egregious / flagrant / glaring / heinous) breach of duty exposed the (iniquity) of the system.* |
| **Scathing, Vitriolic, Acrimonious, Indictment** | adjective | bitterly harsh in criticism; *indictment* is a noun = a formal charge or a damning verdict on something | *The (scathing / vitriolic) report followed an (acrimonious) debate and reads as an (indictment) of the whole scheme.* |

## 👏 Praise, Support & Strengthen ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Abet** | verb | to help someone do something wrong | *Officials were accused of aiding and abetting illegal sand mining.* |
| **Acclaim, Approbation** | noun | strong public praise and approval | *The reform won wide (acclaim / approbation) from economists.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Advocate, Stalwart** | noun | a loyal, reliable supporter of a cause | *She has been a lifelong (advocate / stalwart) of press freedom.* |
| **Backbone, Keystone, Collateral** | noun | the main supporting part on which something rests; *collateral* = the asset pledged to back a loan | *Small farms are the (backbone / keystone) of the rural economy; the loan required land as collateral.* |
| **Bolster, Boost, Underpin, Augment, Foster, Embolden** | verb | to support, strengthen or encourage the growth of something; *underpin* = form the base of; *embolden* = give courage | *The subsidy (bolstered / boosted / augmented / fostered) rural demand; strong institutions underpin democracy; the win emboldened the protesters.* |
| **Boost, Impetus, Stimulus, Incentive** | noun | something that pushes an activity forward or encourages action | *The tax cut gave a much-needed (boost / impetus / stimulus / incentive) to manufacturing.* |
| **Corroborate, Substantiate, Verify** | verb | to prove or back up a claim with evidence | *Independent data (corroborated / substantiated / verified) the whistleblower's account.* |
| **Egalitarian, Meritocracy** | adjective/noun | based on equal treatment or on rising by talent rather than birth | *He pushed an egalitarian tax policy; the exam system is meant to be a meritocracy.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Endeavour** | noun | a serious effort to achieve something | *The mission was a bold scientific endeavour.* |
| **Endorse, Espouse, Advocate, Ratify** | verb | to publicly support, approve or adopt a cause or agreement; *ratify* = formal approval of a treaty | *The party (endorsed / espoused / advocated) the new labour code; Parliament finally ratified the treaty.* |
| **Enfranchise** | verb | to give someone the right to vote or full citizenship rights | *The amendment enfranchised millions of young voters.* |
| **Laud, Hail, Eulogise, Acclaim** | verb | to praise someone or something publicly | *Critics (lauded / hailed / eulogised / acclaimed) the new welfare scheme.* |
| **Laudable, Warranted** | adjective | deserving praise, or justified by the facts | *The effort was (laudable / warranted) given the scale of the crisis.* |
| **Magnanimous, Magnanimity, Munificent, Munificence, Benevolent, Benign, Altruistic, Lavish** | adjective/noun | kind, well-meaning and generous in giving. Magnanimity and munificence are the noun forms; altruistic = selflessly caring for others; benign = gentle and harmless; lavish = giving very freely. | *A (magnanimous / munificent / benevolent / altruistic / lavish) donor funded the school; her (magnanimity / munificence) was widely praised, and the gesture was entirely benign.* |
| **Pledge, Vow, Covenant** | verb/noun | a serious, formal promise; to promise firmly | *The government (pledged / vowed) to double spending on health; the two states signed a covenant on water sharing.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Recoup** | verb | to get back money or losses | *Airlines struggled to recoup pandemic losses.* |
| **Resilience** | noun | the ability to recover quickly after a shock or disaster | *The community showed remarkable resilience after the floods.* |
| **Restoration** | noun | the process of bringing something back to its original state | *The restoration of the old fort took five years.* |
| **Staunch, Steadfast, Stalwart, Resilient** | adjective | firmly loyal, unwavering and able to withstand difficulty | *He remained a (staunch / steadfast / stalwart) defender of the constitution; the economy proved resilient.* |
| **Strengthening, Emulate, Therapeutic, Salubrious, Innocuous, Tractable** | verb/adjective | to build up, back or make stronger; also to copy someone you admire. | *The reform is (strengthening / emulating) the best global practice; the therapeutic and salubrious effects were clear, and the innocuous change met no resistance.* |
| **Thrive** | verb | to grow well and become very successful | *Start-ups thrive where regulation is light.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Venerate, Reverence, Reverent, Venerable, Pious, Sacrosanct, Inviolable** | noun/adjective/verb | deep respect, or showing it. Venerate = to revere deeply (verb); venerable = respected because of age or wisdom; pious = religiously devoted; sacrosanct and inviolable = too sacred or important to be touched or broken. | *Students (venerate / revere) the venerable teacher; he spoke with (reverence / a reverent tone); the pious crowd treated the shrine as (sacrosanct / inviolable).* |
| **Woo, Garner** | verb | to win over or gather support, votes or attention | *The party (wooed / garnered) young voters ahead of the polls.* |

## 🚧 Block, Hinder & Suppress ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Avert, Forestall, Preclude, Obviate, Deter** | verb | to act in time so that something bad never happens; *deter* = to put someone off by fear of consequences, *obviate* = to remove the need for something | *Early warning helped (avert / forestall / preclude) a famine; heavy fines (deter) offenders; a good design (obviates) the need for repairs.* |
| **Blockade, Embargo, Moratorium, Interdict** | noun | an official ban, sealing-off or temporary stop on trade, movement or an activity; *interdict* is also used as a verb = to stop officially | *The council imposed a (blockade / embargo / moratorium) on new mining; patrols (interdict) smuggled goods.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cumbersome, Intractable, Wayward, Fractious, Relentless** | adjective | hard to handle, hard to solve or impossible to stop | *The (cumbersome) rulebook makes an (intractable) problem worse; a (wayward / fractious) coalition faced (relentless) pressure.* |
| **Deplete, Forfeit, Cede, Capitulate, Abandon** | verb | to use up, give up or surrender something; *deplete* = to drain a stock, *forfeit* = to lose as a penalty | *Drought (depletes) reserves; the club had to (forfeit) the match; rebels chose to (cede / capitulate) rather than fight on, and (abandon) their posts.* |
| **Docile, Mollycoddle, Complacent, Indolent** | adjective | easily controlled, over-protected or too relaxed to act; *mollycoddle* is a verb = to pamper | *A (docile) workforce asks no questions; parents who (mollycoddle) children raise (complacent / indolent) adults.* |
| **Halt, Stall, Stem, Throttle, Quell, Subdue** | verb | to stop, hold back or bring under control, sometimes by force; *quell / subdue* = put down resistance | *Troops moved to (halt / stem / quell / subdue) the riot; red tape (stalls / throttles) new projects.* |
| **Hamper, Hinder, Impede, Stymie, Thwart, Derail, Disrupt** | verb | to block, slow down or spoil something so it cannot go forward | *Bad roads (hamper / hinder / impede / stymie / thwart) relief work; protesters tried to (derail / disrupt) the talks.* |
| **Interregnum, Hiatus, Ceasefire, Cancellation** | noun | a pause, gap or break in an ongoing activity or rule | *A three-month (hiatus / interregnum) followed the (cancellation) of the session; both sides agreed to a (ceasefire).* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Obfuscate, Obscure, Opaque, Nebulous, Vague, Ambiguous, Equivocal** | adjective | unclear, hazy or hard to see through; *obfuscate* is a verb = to make unclear on purpose, *equivocal* = deliberately vague to avoid commitment | *The reply was (vague / ambiguous / nebulous / equivocal); the accounts stay (opaque / obscure) because officials (obfuscate) the figures.* |
| **Pedestrianised** | verb | restrict access to to pedestrians only, disallowing motor vehicles | *In the big pedestrianised square Plaza de Olavide, fans had gathered around screens, some sitting on the ground while children and dogs ran around.* |
| **Repression, Subjugate, Yoke, Authoritarianism, Totalitarianism, Authoritarian, Regime** | noun | harsh control that crushes people's freedom; *authoritarian* = a ruler demanding total obedience, *regime* = the ruling government itself | *Under the (regime), (repression) and the (yoke) of censorship grew; (authoritarianism / totalitarianism) leaves no room for dissent; the army moved to (subjugate) the region.* |
| **Suppression, Prohibition, Nullify, Ostracise, Sanctioned, Deportation, Extradition, Imprisonment, Protectionism** | noun/verb | to stop, forbid, cancel or push something down by force of authority. Note: *sanctioned* is a contronym — it usually means hit with official penalties, but can also mean officially approved; read the context. | *The order brought (suppression / prohibition) of the protest; the ruling nullified the licence, activists were ostracised and sanctioned, and deportation, extradition and imprisonment followed under a wall of protectionism.* |

## ⚔️ Conflict, Crisis & Disorder ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Belligerent, Pugnacious, Truculent** | adjective | aggressive and eager to fight or argue | *He turned (belligerent / pugnacious / truculent) when questioned.* |
| **Cataclysm, Fiasco, Turbulence, Reel, Brunt, Knell, Nemesis, Pyrrhic** | noun/verb | a violent disturbance, a total failure, or the shock that follows one. | *The policy ended in a (cataclysm / fiasco); the turbulence made markets reel, the poor bore the brunt, and it sounded the knell for the party's old nemesis.* |
| **Debacle, Travesty** | noun | a humiliating failure or a mockery of the real thing | *The rollout was a debacle; the inquiry was a travesty of justice.* |
| **Diplomacy, Neutrality, Proxy, Compromise** | noun | managing conflict without direct war | *Diplomacy = managing relations between states through talks; neutrality = refusing to take sides; a proxy is a group fighting on another's behalf; a compromise is a deal where each side gives something up (compromise can also mean to weaken or expose something).* |
| **Factional, Polarise, Polarisation, Schism, Partition, Secession, Cleave** | verb/noun/adjective | splitting into rival or separate parts | *Factional fighting (polarised / cleaved) the party; the polarisation deepened into an open schism,* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *echoing the partition of 1947 and later demands for secession.* |
| **Hostilities, Discord, Opposition, Grievance** | noun | open fighting, disagreement or complaint | *Hostilities resumed along the border; discord within the party grew as the opposition seized on a long-standing grievance.* |
| **Impasse, Stalemate** | noun | a situation where neither side can move forward | *Talks reached an (impasse / stalemate).* |
| **Insurgency, Belligerence, Brinkmanship, Fraught, Precarious, Resistance, Dissent, Dissident, Disobedience, Interference** | noun/adjective | hostility, armed opposition, open disagreement, or a dangerously tense situation. | *The (insurgency / belligerence / brinkmanship) put the region on edge; (dissent / disobedience / resistance) spread, dissidents were arrested, and the situation grew (fraught / precarious) amid foreign interference.* |
| **Kowtow, Obsequious** | verb/adjective | behaving in a weak, servile way to please the powerful | *Officials kowtow to the minister; his obsequious praise embarrassed everyone.* |
| **Schadenfreude** | noun | pleasure taken in another person's misfortune | *There was open schadenfreude at the rival firm's collapse.* |
| **Turmoil, Upheaval, Tumultuous, Turbulent** | noun/adjective | great disorder, confusion or violent change | *The country passed through (turmoil / upheaval) in a* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *(tumultuous / turbulent) decade.* |

## 💥 Harm, Damage & Worsen ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Aggravate, Exacerbate** | verb | to make a bad situation worse | *Fresh curbs only (aggravate / exacerbate) the shortage.* |
| **Annihilate, Demolish, Eradicate, Destruction, Elimination, Discard, Truncate** | verb/noun | to get rid of something completely, or cut it down. | *The blast (annihilated / demolished / eradicated) the block; the (destruction / elimination) was total, the debris was discarded, and the report was truncated.* |
| **Hapless, Fortuitous, Random** | adjective | governed by chance rather than plan; *hapless* = unlucky and helpless, *fortuitous* = luckily unplanned | *The (hapless) crew survived by a (fortuitous), (random) turn of the tide.* |

## 🔥 Severity, Seriousness & Urgency ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Austerity** | noun | strict economic policy with sharply reduced public spending | *Years of austerity hollowed out public services.* |
| **Backlash** | noun | a strong, angry public reaction against | *The order triggered a fierce backlash from* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | something | *farmers.* |
| **Breach** | noun | the breaking of a rule, law or promise | *The order was a clear breach of privacy law.* |
| **Coerce, Compel, Goad, Provoke** | verb | to force, push or deliberately drive someone into acting; *goad/provoke* = to needle into a reaction | *Officials (coerced / compelled) traders to comply; the remarks (goaded / provoked) the crowd.* |
| **Comeuppance** | noun | a punishment or fate that is justly deserved | *The scam's masterminds finally got their comeuppance.* |
| **Compound, Fester, Escalate** | verb | to make a bad situation worse or grow more serious over time | *Delays (compounded / escalated) the crisis; the grievance was left to fester.* |
| **Corruption** | noun | the act of impairing integrity or moral principle; dishonest use of power | *Corruption in procurement drained the budget.* |
| **Daunting, Imminent, Looming** | adjective | frighteningly difficult, or about to happen very soon | *The task was daunting, with an (imminent / looming) deadline.* |
| **Dire, Acute, Drastic, Stringent, Onerous, Gruelling** | adjective | extremely serious, severe or hard to bear; *stringent* = strict; *onerous/gruelling* = heavy and exhausting | *The report warned of a (dire / acute) water shortage; the government took drastic steps and imposed stringent rules; the onerous, gruelling paperwork deterred applicants.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Escalation** | noun | a rise in the intensity of a conflict or dispute | *Both sides warned against further escalation along the border.* |
| **Famine, Starvation** | noun | severe, widespread lack of food causing hunger and death | *Drought pushed the region towards (famine / starvation).* |
| **Fervent, Vehement, Emphatic, Trenchant, Compelling** | adjective | expressed with strong, forceful feeling or conviction; *trenchant* = sharp and cutting; *compelling* = very convincing | *She made a (fervent / vehement / emphatic) appeal for calm; his trenchant, compelling critique changed the debate.* |
| **Implore, Urge** | verb | to request strongly and earnestly | *Doctors (implored / urged) the public to stay indoors.* |
| **Indict, Allege, Blame** | verb | to accuse someone of wrongdoing; *indict* = formally charge | *The agency (indicted / blamed) the contractor and alleged large-scale fraud.* |
| **Jingoism, Populism, Autocracy, Clientelism** | noun | political styles based on aggressive nationalism, mass appeal, one-man rule, or favour-trading | *The speech slid into jingoism; critics saw populism, clientelism and creeping autocracy in the new order.* |
| **Levity, Frivolous** | noun/adjective | lack of seriousness; treating a serious matter lightly | *There is no room for levity in a public health crisis; the court dismissed the frivolous petition.* |
| **Loom** | verb | to appear close and threatening; to be about to happen | *A fresh crisis looms over the sector.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Plea** | noun | an urgent and emotional request | *The court heard a plea for immediate relief.* |
| **Sanction** | noun/verb | a penalty imposed on a country; or, oppositely, official permission | *The council imposed sanctions on the regime; the ministry sanctioned the new post.* |
| **Significant** | adjective | large or important enough to matter, especially in results | *The trial showed a significant drop in infections.* |
| **Systemic** | adjective | affecting a whole system, not just one part; built into how things work | *The audit exposed systemic failures in the supply chain.* |
| **Zealot, Hardliner, Demagogue** | noun | a person holding extreme, uncompromising views; *demagogue* = a leader who stirs emotion rather than facts | *The party was captured by (zealots / hardliners); the campaign was led by a demagogue.* |

## ❓ Difference, Disagreement & Doubt ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Defy, Flout, Spurn, Repudiate, Disenfranchise** | verb | to openly refuse, reject or strip away; *flout* = to break a rule openly, *disenfranchise* = to take away someone's rights | *Traders (defy / flout) the ban and (spurn / repudiate) the deal; the new list (disenfranchises) thousands of voters.* |
| **Demonstrators** | noun | One who demonstrates | *On Tuesday night, demonstrators' calls were answered as the* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | anything, or proves beyond doubt | *Ukrainian president fired the general and offered Mr Fedorov a "prominent" role and promised an overhaul of the army command.* |
| **dis-, mis-** | prefix | prefixes meaning 'opposite / away' (dis-) and 'wrong / badly' (mis-) | *(dis-) gives disagree, dishonest, disappear; (mis-) gives misunderstand, misguide, misuse.* |
| **Disappointment, Deficit** | noun | a shortfall — of expectation or of money | *The result was a (disappointment); the budget showed a widening (deficit).* |
| **Disparate, Discordant, Contentious, Tussle** | adjective | clashing or likely to cause conflict; *tussle* is a noun = a struggle for control | *A (disparate / discordant) alliance took up the (contentious) bill, and a long (tussle) followed.* |
| **Disparity, Discrepancy, Deviation, Inconsistencies, Gulf, Fissure, Lacuna, Margin, Margin of error, Outlier** | noun | a gap, mismatch or difference between things that should match; *lacuna* = a missing part in a law or argument, *outlier* = a value far from the rest | *The (disparity / discrepancy / gulf / fissure) between the two figures was clear; auditors flagged (deviation), (inconsistencies), a (lacuna) in the rules, a wide (margin) / (margin of error), and one (outlier).* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Misconception, Misnomer, Misinformation, Misrepresented, Misunderstood, Perplex, Anomaly, Aberration** | noun/verb/adjective | a wrong idea, or the act of getting something wrong or being wrongly named. | *The claim rests on a (misconception / misnomer / piece of misinformation); the data was (misrepresented / misunderstood), which perplexed readers, and the anomaly proved to be a mere aberration.* |
| **Nuance, Threshold, Benchmark, Yardstick** | noun | a fine distinction or a fixed point used for comparison; *nuance* = a small but important shade of meaning | *Every (nuance) matters once a score crosses the (threshold); the scheme became the (benchmark / yardstick) for others.* |
| **Tantamount** | adjective | equal to or the same as something (usually something bad) | *Silence here is (tantamount) to consent.* |
| **Uncertainty, Vacillate, Inconclusive** | noun | doubt or the inability to settle on an answer; *vacillate* is a verb = to keep changing your mind | *(Uncertainty) grew as the tests stayed (inconclusive) and the board continued to (vacillate).* |
| **Untenable, Purported, Incredulous, Credulous, Cynical, Perfidious, Perfidy, Complicit, Ambivalent, Prejudicial** | adjective/noun | not believable, refusing to believe, or breaking trust. | *The defence is (untenable / purported at best); she was incredulous while a credulous public accepted it; his cynical view proved right when the (perfidious / complicit) aide's perfidy came out.* |

##  Beginnings, Change & Turning Points ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Amend, Adaptation, Overhaul, Intervention** | noun/verb | a change made to fix or improve something | *Parliament may amend the Act; the tax system needs a complete overhaul; adaptation to a warmer climate now requires state intervention.* |
| **Entrench, Hidebound, Persist, Obdurate, Obstinate, Intransigent, Adamant** | adjective/verb | refusing to change, or fixed so firmly it cannot be changed | *Caste privilege is deeply entrenched; a hidebound bureaucracy resists reform and old habits persist; the union stayed (obdurate / obstinate / intransigent / adamant) through eight rounds of talks.* |
| **Heterodox** | adjective | not following accepted or usual beliefs | *She defended a heterodox view of growth.* |
| **Nascent, Fledgling, Outset** | adjective/noun | at the very beginning; new and inexperienced | *The (nascent / fledgling) industry needs protection; the flaw was obvious from the outset.* |
| **Opportunities, Possibility, Feasibility, Feasible, Viable** | noun/adjective | a chance, or whether something can practically be done | *Reform opened up new opportunities and raised the possibility of growth; a feasibility study found the plan (feasible / viable).* |
| **Procrastinate** | verb | to keep putting off what must be done | *The ministry procrastinated for years before acting.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tentative** | adjective | not final or certain; a first attempt that may change | *The two sides reached a tentative agreement.* |
| **Usher, Kindle, Spark, Prompt, Galvanise, Mobilise, Catalyst** | verb/noun | to set something off or stir people into action | *The verdict (sparked / prompted / kindled) protests and (galvanised / mobilised) the opposition; it ushered in a new era and became the catalyst for reform.* |
| **Volatile, Mercurial, Instability, Vicissitude** | adjective/noun | changing suddenly and unpredictably | *Oil prices remain (volatile / unstable); his mercurial temper unsettled the cabinet; instability and the vicissitudes of politics stalled the project.* |
| **Watershed, Paradigm, Transition, Trend, Baseline** | noun | a turning point, model or direction of change | *1991 was a watershed year that marked a paradigm shift; the transition to renewables is the clear trend, measured against a 2005 baseline.* |

## 💰 Wealth, Money & Economy ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Affluent, Opulent, Lucrative** | adjective | rich, or producing wealth | *They live in an (affluent / opulent) neighbourhood; software turned out to be a lucrative* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *business. Note: opulent stresses visible luxury; lucrative = profit-making.* |
| **Arrears, Indebtedness, Creditor, Leverage, Liquidity, Coffer** | noun | debt, what is owed, and available money | *Arrears = overdue payments; indebtedness = the burden of owing a lot; a creditor is the one owed; leverage = borrowed money used to chase bigger profits; liquidity = how easily assets turn into spendable cash; the state's coffers are its store of funds.* |
| **Contribution, Contributions, Contributing** | noun/verb | something given that becomes part of a larger whole. | *Each member's (contribution / contributions) mattered; every donor contributing to the fund was named.* |
| **Destitute** | adjective | extremely poor, lacking even food and shelter | *The floods left thousands destitute.* |
| **Fiscal, Monetary, Neoliberalism, Industrialisation** | noun/adjective | terms describing economic policy and economic change | *Fiscal policy covers government spending and taxes, while monetary policy covers money supply and interest rates; neoliberalism favours free markets and trade liberalisation; industrialisation is the shift from a pre-* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *industrial to an industrial economy.* |
| **Frugal, Husbandry** | adjective/noun | careful, non-wasteful management of money and resources | *A frugal household saves where it can; careful husbandry of water made the district drought-proof.* |
| **Generous** | adjective | willing to give freely (opposite: stingy) | *A generous donor funded the entire wing.* |
| **Indigent, Penurious, Penury, Parsimonious, Prodigal, Rapacious, Scarce, Negligible** | adjective/noun | extremely poor, or unwilling to spend. Prodigal is the opposite — wastefully extravagant; rapacious = aggressively greedy. | *The (indigent / penurious / parsimonious) household had nothing to spare; penury forced the sale, while his prodigal brother squandered a fortune and a rapacious lender took the rest.* |
| **Largesse, Subsidy, Bailout, Redistribution, Remittance, Reparations, Allocate** | noun/verb | money handed out, transferred or set aside | *Allocate = to set money aside for a purpose; subsidy = government money to lower a cost; bailout = emergency rescue money for a failing firm or bank; largesse = generous giving by the powerful; redistribution = sharing wealth more evenly through tax and welfare; remittance = money sent home by workers abroad; reparations =* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *money paid for war damage.* |
| **Levy, Default, Commodity, Volatility, Overheating, Insolvent, Sovereign, Macroeconomic, Globalisation, Affordable, Unaffordable, Subscription, Transactional, Misappropriation, Optimization** | noun/adjective | terms about money, markets, trade and the wider economy. | *A new (levy / default / commodity) shock triggered volatility; overheating followed, firms turned insolvent, and sovereign debt strained the macroeconomic outlook amid globalisation.* |
| **Livelihood** | noun | the way a person earns a living | *The ban destroyed the livelihood of thousands of weavers.* |
| **Magnate, Billionaires, Plutocracy** | noun | the very rich, and rule by them | *A steel magnate and two billionaires bankrolled the campaign; critics call the system a plutocracy.* |
| **Ostentatious** | adjective | showing off wealth to impress others | *His ostentatious wedding drew sharp criticism.* |
| **Prosperity** | noun | the state of being rich and doing well | *Two decades of reform brought unprecedented prosperity.* |
| **Recovery, Resurgence** | noun | a rise or return to health after a fall | *The data point to a (recovery / resurgence) in rural demand.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Squander, Fritter, Profligate, Cupidity, Venal, Embezzle** | verb/adjective | to waste money, or greed and corruption over money | *The board (squandered / frittered away) a decade of profits; profligate spending emptied the treasury; cupidity and venal officials let one clerk embezzle the pension fund. Note: embezzle = steal money you were trusted with.* |
| **Voracious** | adjective | wanting a very large amount; greedy or intensely eager | *The country has a voracious appetite for imported oil.* |

## 🎯 Skill, Care & Wisdom ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Acumen** | noun | the ability to think and judge quickly and well | *Her business acumen saved the firm.* |
| **Adept, Adroit, Deft, Nimble** | adjective | skilful, clever and quick | *She is (adept / adroit / deft / nimble) at handling hostile questions.* |
| **Assiduous, Erudite, Versatile, Discernment, Arduous, Equanimity, Sangfroid** | adjective/noun | showing careful effort, sound judgement, wide learning or calm control. | *She is (assiduous / erudite / versatile) and known for her discernment; the arduous negotiation demanded (equanimity / sangfroid).* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cautious, Wary** | adjective | careful about possible danger | *Investors remain (cautious / wary) about the new rules.* |
| **Heuristic, Estimate, Variable, Control, Empirical, Correlate, Correlation, Consistent** | noun/verb/adjective | the vocabulary of testing, measuring and reasoning from evidence | *A heuristic is a rough rule of thumb; an estimate is a careful guess; a variable is a factor that changes and is measured; a control group gets no treatment and is used for comparison; empirical claims rest on observation rather than theory; two things correlate when they move together, and that link is a correlation; results are consistent when they hold from test to test.* |
| **Inept** | adjective | lacking skill; clumsy and incompetent | *The rescue effort was hopelessly inept.* |
| **Meticulous, Painstaking, Diligent, Systematic, Scrutiny** | adjective/noun | careful, thorough and methodical | *The audit was (meticulous / painstaking / systematic) and the team diligent; every claim was put under close scrutiny.* |
| **Ontological** | adjective | concerning the nature of being and what really exists | *The debate turned on an ontological question about what a nation is.* |
| **Sagacious, Sage, Prudent, Nuanced** | adjective | wise and showing good judgement | *It was a (sagacious / sage / prudent) decision; his nuanced* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *reading of the data impressed the panel. Note: nuanced = alive to fine distinctions.* |
| **Systematically** | adverb | in an organised, methodical way | *Records were systematically destroyed.* |

## 🗣️ Speech, Persuasion & Claims ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Albeit, Whereby, Insofar, insofar as, Henceforth, Hitherto, Previously, Conceivably, Presumably, Ostensibly, Fundamentally, Electronically, Erstwhile** | conjunction/adverb | Connectors, hedges and time markers that join, limit or soften a statement. | *The scheme works, (albeit / insofar as / whereby) only in part; henceforth the rule applies, hitherto it did not, and previously it was optional; (conceivably / presumably / ostensibly) it will change; fundamentally the idea is sound; forms may be filed electronically; the erstwhile chairman said nothing.* |
| **Arguably, Purportedly** | adverb | as can reasonably be claimed, or as claimed by others without proof | *It is arguably the biggest reform in a decade; the funds were purportedly spent on training.* |
| **Cogent, Grandstanding, Performative,** | adjective/noun | convincing argument, formal statements, or | *His case was cogent, the rest pure (grandstanding /* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Affirmation, Announcement, Insistence, Memorandum, Interrogation, Caveat, Litany, Querulous** | | speaking mainly to be seen. | *performative) talk; the (affirmation / announcement / memorandum) was read out, his insistence grew, and the interrogation produced a litany of querulous complaints despite one important caveat.* |
| **Confound** | verb | to confuse a result by mixing in a hidden cause | *Income differences confounded the study's conclusions.* |
| **Contend, Posit** | verb | to put forward a claim or idea as true so it can be debated or tested | *The authors (contend / posit) that growth alone will not cut inequality.* |
| **Eloquent, Lucid, Limpid, Pellucid** | adjective | clear, fluent and easy to follow; *eloquent* stresses persuasive skill | *Her (eloquent / lucid / limpid / pellucid) explanation won the house over.* |
| **Elucidate, Delineate, Demonstrate, Indicate, Manifest, Underscore, Promulgate, Emanate, Analyse, Observe** | verb | to make something clear, visible, known or pointed out. | *The chart (elucidates / delineates / demonstrates / indicates / manifests) the trend; the study underscored the risk, the ministry promulgated the rule, and the warning emanated from the data they analysed and observed.* |
| **Gambit, Machination** | noun | a calculated move or secret scheme made to gain advantage | *The walkout was a political gambit; the machinations of the* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *lobby were later exposed.* |
| **Methodology** | noun | the set of methods used to carry out research | *The paper's methodology was criticised by statisticians.* |
| **Normative** | adjective | about how things should be, based on rules or values, not just how they are | *The report makes a normative case for free school meals.* |
| **Notwithstanding, per se** | preposition/phrase | in spite of; and *per se* = in itself, taken on its own | *Notwithstanding the delays, work continued; the rule is not unfair per se.* |
| **Paradox, Dichotomy** | noun | a self-contradictory statement, or a sharp split into two opposed parts | *It is a paradox that food-surplus states report hunger; the growth-versus-environment dichotomy dominates the debate.* |
| **Plausible** | adjective | believable and reasonable enough to be true | *The explanation is plausible but unproven.* |
| **Qualified, Provisional, Stopgap** | adjective | limited, temporary or not final; *qualified* support = support with conditions | *The party gave (qualified / provisional) backing; the ordinance is only a stopgap.* |
| **Quandary** | noun | a difficult situation where it is hard to decide what to do | *The board faced a quandary over the merger.* |
| **Reiterate** | verb | to say something again for emphasis | *The minister reiterated that no tax would rise.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Replicate** | verb | to repeat a study or test to check the result holds | *No team could replicate the original finding.* |
| **Rhetoric, Discourse, Dialectic** | noun | public argument and discussion on a topic; *rhetoric* often implies empty persuasive language | *The campaign was heavy on rhetoric; the public discourse and its dialectic of opposing views produced little.* |

## ⚡ Strong Feeling, Energy & Zeal ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Apathetic, Apathy, Jaded, Catharsis, Frustration, Sentimental, Empathy** | adjective/noun | feeling nothing, worn out by too much of something, or the release of pent-up emotion. | *Voters have grown (apathetic / jaded); the apathy runs deep, and the verdict brought a strange catharsis after months of frustration.* |
| **Ardent, Zealous, Vociferous** | adjective | passionate and forceful in support of something | *He is an (ardent / zealous / vociferous) defender of press freedom. Note: vociferous stresses loudness.* |
| **Captivate** | verb | to attract and hold someone's attention completely | *Her speech captivated the audience.* |
| **Daunt, Vex, Hubris** | verb/noun | to discourage or trouble someone, or the pride that invites a fall | *The scale of the task did not daunt her, though delays continued to vex the team; the collapse was* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *a classic case of hubris.* |
| **Enthusiastic, Confidence, Aspiration, Motivation, Fascination, Attainable** | noun/adjective | eagerness, self-belief and the drive to achieve something. | *Her (enthusiasm / confidence / aspiration / motivation) carried the team; the fascination with the goal never faded, and the target proved attainable.* |
| **Invigorate** | verb | to give fresh energy to | *The new coach invigorated a tired side.* |
| **Sanguine, Halcyon** | adjective | hopeful, or calm and happy | *He stayed sanguine about the outcome; they look back on the halcyon days of the 1990s.* |
| **Vibrant, Kinetic, Robust** | adjective | full of energy, movement and strength | *A (vibrant / kinetic) start-up scene and robust demand lifted the city.* |
| **Vie, Bid, Competition, Competitive** | verb/noun | to try hard to win or obtain something against others. | *Firms (vie / compete) for the contract; the bid was strong, and the competition remained fiercely competitive.* |
| **Zeal** | noun | great energy and enthusiasm for a cause | *She campaigned with missionary zeal.* |

## 🔍 Examination, Judgement & Standards ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Scrutinise, Investigate, Probe, Assess, Gauge, Ascertain, Quantify** | verb | to examine, measure or establish something; *probe* is also a noun = an investigation | *Auditors (scrutinise / investigate / probe) the accounts to (assess / gauge / ascertain) the loss and (quantify) it.* |
| **Survey, Sample, Data, Ratio, Demographic, Traceability, Examination, Linear, Surveillance** | noun/adjective | gathering, counting, tracking and studying information. | *The (survey / sample / data / ratio) showed a clear pattern; the demographic breakdown, traceability of each figure and the examination method were all checked.* |
| **Temperatures** | noun | measure of cold or heat, often measurable with a thermometer | *This summer, high temperatures have become inescapable.* |

## 🤝 Agreement, Unity & Cooperation ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Abide, Adhere, Compliance, Accede, Persuade, Co-opt, Stipulate** | verb | to follow, agree to, or bring someone round; *compliance* is a noun = the act of obeying, *stipulate* = to set a condition | *Firms must (abide) by and (adhere) to the code, and (compliance) is checked; the state (acceded) to the demand after leaders (persuaded / co-opted) the rebels, and the pact (stipulates) an annual review.* |
| **Accord, Consensus, Coalition, Cohesion,** | noun | a coming-together, a deal, or the process | *After long (negotiation / parley)* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Combination, Convergence, Negotiation, Conference, Parley, Ratification** | | of reaching one; *ratification* = the formal approval that makes a deal binding | *at the (conference), the (coalition) reached an (accord) by (consensus); the (combination / convergence / cohesion) of views survived (ratification).* |
| **co-/con-, co/con, uni** | prefix | prefixes meaning 'with / together' (co-, con-) and 'one' (uni-) | *(co-/con-) gives cooperate, connect, coexist; (co/con) gives collaborate, contract; (uni) gives unite, unique, universe.* |
| **Coalesce, Converge, Reconcile, Mediate, Arbitrate, Convene** | verb | to bring or come together, or to settle differences; *mediate* = help two sides agree, *arbitrate* = decide as a neutral judge | *The factions (coalesce / converge) once talks (reconcile) their demands; the panel was (convened) to (mediate / arbitrate) the dispute.* |
| **Cohesive, Compatible, Multilateral, Unilateral, Aggregate, Cumulative, Incremental** | adjective | united, matching, or added together; *unilateral* = done alone, *multilateral* = by many together | *A (cohesive / compatible) team took the (multilateral) route rather than a (unilateral) one; the (aggregate / cumulative) effect of (incremental) steps was large.* |
| **Rapprochement, Reconciliation, Collaboration, Cooperation, Cooperative, Collective, Acquiesce, Accommodate,** | noun/verb | working together, giving way, or restoring good relations after trouble. | *The talks produced (rapprochement / reconciliation); (collaboration / cooperation) replaced hostility, both sides acquiesced and conceded ground, and* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Concede, Inclusive, Relationships, Hospitality, Invitation** | | | *the new cooperative accommodated every stakeholder.* |
| **Solidarity** | noun | bond of unity or agreement between individuals, united around a common goal or against a common enemy, such as the unifying principle that d | *A long time union member himself, Phil showed solidarity with the picketing grocery store workers by shopping at a competing, unionized store.* |

## ⭐ Certainty, Importance & Authority ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Conscription** | noun | Involuntary labor, especially military service, demanded by some established authority | *The pair also butted heads over Mr Fedorov's plans to improve recruitment and training to reduce the deep anger created by the conscription system .* |
| **Conspicuous, Palpable, Pronounced, Discernible, Salient, Explicit, Notable, Notifiable, Distinctive, Characteristic, Facet** | adjective | easy to see, notice or single out. | *The shift was (conspicuous / palpable / pronounced / discernible / salient); the wording was explicit, the finding (notable / distinctive), and each characteristic facet was set out.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Electricity** NEW | noun | Originally, a property of amber and certain other nonconducting substances to attract lightweight material when rubbed, or the cause of this | *A £2 cap on bus fares, a cut in VAT on electricity, and some business rates relief for pubs, clubs and smaller music venues were all modest moves.* |
| **Impeccable, Inimitable, Irresistible, Epitome, Quintessential, Pristine** | adjective/noun | so good that it cannot be faulted or copied. Epitome and quintessential = the perfect example of a type; pristine = spotless or untouched. | *Her record is (impeccable / inimitable / irresistible); she is the (epitome / quintessential example) of a public servant, and the site remains pristine.* |
| **Inescapable** | adjective | Impossible to avoid or escape | *This summer, high temperatures have become inescapable.* |
| **Inevitable, Ineluctable, Inexorable, Indubitable, Unequivocal** | adjective | certain, unstoppable or beyond doubt; *inexorable* stresses that nothing can halt it | *Defeat looked (inevitable / ineluctable / inexorable); the evidence was (indubitable / unequivocal).* |
| **Inherent, Intrinsic, Innate, Indispensable, Requisite, Cardinal** | adjective/noun | belonging to something by its very nature, or absolutely required. | *Risk is (inherent / intrinsic / innate) in the job; trust is (indispensable / requisite) for progress, and openness is a cardinal principle.* |
| **Investigating** | verb | inquire into or study in order to ascertain facts or information | *Fire kills 10 members of same family in Peru, police say* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *Authorities are investigating the cause of the blaze in Lima as local media report it may have been arson.* |
| **Jurisdictions** NEW | noun | power, right, or authority to interpret and apply the law | *India's foreign policy must look seaward Indian seafarers need protection beyond borders, flags, and jurisdictions* |
| **Paramount, Predominant, Incumbent, Mandate, Remit, Legislative, Democracy, Sovereignty, Autonomy, Privatisation** | noun | authority, its scope, or its source; *paramount / predominant* are adjectives = above all others, *incumbent* = the current office-holder or a binding duty | *Safety is (paramount) and the (predominant) concern; the (incumbent) claims a (mandate) within the (remit) of the (legislative) branch, which in a (democracy) rests on (sovereignty) and regional (autonomy); (privatisation) was approved.* |
| **Unequivocally, Ergo, Hence, Thereby, Thus** | adverb | words that link a conclusion to its reason, or state it without doubt | *The data is clear; (ergo / hence / thus / thereby) the policy fails, and the panel (unequivocally) rejected it.* |

## 🌫 Hidden, Unclear & Secret ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Arcane, Cryptic, Esoteric, Recondite, Abstruse** | adjective | mysterious, obscure and understood by only a few | *The rules are (arcane / cryptic / esoteric / recondite / abstruse) even to lawyers.* |
| **Clandestine, Furtive** | adjective | done secretly to avoid notice, often something illicit | *The (clandestine / furtive) meetings were caught on camera.* |
| **Divulge** | verb | to reveal secret information | *The officer refused to divulge the source.* |
| **Gloss over, Belie** | verb | to hide or play down something bad so it seems less serious | *The report (glossed over / belied) the true scale of the losses.* |
| **Latent, Underlying** | adjective | existing but not yet visible or active; lying beneath the surface | *The (latent / underlying) causes of the unrest went unaddressed.* |
| **Obfuscation** | noun | deliberately making something confusing to hide the truth | *The reply was pure obfuscation.* |
| **Surreptitious, Inscrutable, Enigmatic, Abscond, Aloof, Insular, Dormant, Liminal, Ineffable** | adjective/verb | kept out of sight, held back, or impossible to read or interpret. | *His (surreptitious / inscrutable / enigmatic) conduct raised doubts; he absconded before the inquiry, staying (aloof / insular) from colleagues, while the case sat dormant at a liminal stage.* |
| **Tacit, Implicit** | adjective | understood or implied without being said directly | *There was (tacit / implicit) approval from the top.* |
| **Transparent** | adjective | letting light through; open and easy to see | *The process must be transparent and auditable.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | into (opposite of opaque) | |
| **Veneer** | noun | a thin, often false, outer appearance | *Beneath the veneer of order lay deep dysfunction.* |

## 🧱 Real, Concrete & Practical ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tangible, Pragmatic** | adjective | real and practical rather than theoretical | *Voters want tangible results and a pragmatic approach.* |
| **Vaccination** | noun | giving a vaccine to protect against a disease | *A mass (vaccination) drive covered every district.* |

## ✊ Reject, Revenge & Force ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Depose, Oust, Usurp, Wrest, Annex, Annexation, Coup, Insurrection** | verb | to seize power or territory by force, or to throw someone out of it; *annexation / coup / insurrection* are nouns naming such acts | *Generals (deposed / ousted) the president and (usurped / wrested) control in a (coup); the (insurrection) let them (annex) the border district, an (annexation) no one recognised.* |
| **Insurmountable, Indomitable, Impervious, Indefatigable,** | adjective | so strong, fixed or persistent that nothing can | *The lead looked (insurmountable / indomitable); he was impervious to* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Tenacious, Incessant, Insatiable, Sustained** | | overcome, affect or exhaust it. | *criticism, (indefatigable / tenacious) in his work, and the incessant, insatiable demand was sustained for years.* |
| **Reprisal, Retaliation, Jeopardise, Abrogate, Annul** | noun | revenge, or the cancelling / risking of something; *jeopardise* = to put at risk, *abrogate / annul* = to cancel officially | *Fear of (reprisal / retaliation) grew; the strike would (jeopardise) the truce, and parliament moved to (abrogate / annul) the treaty.* |

## ⏳ Time, Lateness & Approach ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Abrupt** | adjective | sudden and unexpected | *The scheme came to an abrupt end.* |
| **Belated** | adjective | coming later than it should | *A belated apology was issued.* |
| **Bleak, Dismal, Despondent, Lugubrious** | adjective | gloomy and without hope; *despondent* describes a person's low mood | *The outlook was (bleak / dismal); relatives looked (despondent / lugubrious) outside the hospital.* |
| **Disenchant** | verb | to make someone lose hope or trust | *Voters were disenchanted by the broken promises.* |
| **Ephemeral, Transient** | adjective | lasting only a very short time | *The gains proved (ephemeral / transient).* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Harbinger** | noun | a sign of something to come | *The rains were a harbinger of a good harvest.* |
| **Juncture, Preliminary, Prevailing, Prospective, Trajectory, Unprecedented, Anticipatory, Precedence, Preparation, Preservation** | noun/adjective | words marking when something happens or where it falls in an order. | *At this (juncture) the preliminary stage ended; the prevailing view is that the prospective trajectory is upward, which would be unprecedented; anticipatory planning took precedence over preparation.* |
| **Lull** | noun/verb | a quiet or calm period | *There was a brief lull in the fighting.* |
| **Sporadic, Peripatetic, Sedentary, Occurrence, Appearance, Disappearance, Destination, Introduction, Inveterate, Capricious, Unpredictable** | adjective/noun | how often or how much something moves or happens. | *Attacks were (sporadic / occasional); the peripatetic inspector kept moving while the sedentary staff stayed put; each occurrence, appearance and disappearance was logged.* |

## 🎭 Lies, Trickery & Deception ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Chicanery** | noun | clever trickery used to deceive | *The deal was pushed through by legal chicanery.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Deceive, Dissemble, Beguile, Prevaricate** | verb | to mislead by hiding the truth; *beguile* also = to charm; *prevaricate* = to dodge rather than lie outright | *He set out to (deceive / dissemble / beguile) investors; the witness prevaricated for an hour.* |
| **Dubious** | adjective | doubtful and possibly not honest or true | *The firm has a dubious record on safety.* |
| **Fabricate** | verb | to make up something false | *The dossier was entirely fabricated.* |
| **Mendacious, Duplicitous, Spurious, Specious** | adjective | false or dishonest; *specious* = looks correct but is actually false; *duplicitous* = two-faced | *The (mendacious / duplicitous) testimony rested on (spurious / specious) claims.* |
| **Sycophant, Sycophancy, Unctuous, Glib, Facile, Servile** | noun/adjective | excessive false praise given to win favour, or smooth but hollow speech. | *The court is full of (sycophants / sycophancy); his (glib / unctuous / facile) praise fooled nobody, and the servile staff never disagreed.* |

## 🤦 Problems, Obstacles & Setbacks ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Adversity, Plight, Predicament, Quagmire, Morass, Imbroglio, Conundrum** | noun | a difficult, messy or confusing situation | *The migrants' plight worsened; the government is stuck in a (quagmire / morass / imbroglio / predicament) of its own making and faces the conundrum of* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *how to exit; she rose despite great adversity.* |
| **Bane, Disadvantages** | noun | a cause of trouble; a drawback | *Corruption is the bane of the system; the disadvantages of the scheme soon became clear.* |
| **Demarcate** | verb | to mark out boundaries or limits | *The order demarcates the forest area.* |
| **Grapple, Tackle, Extricate** | verb | to struggle with and deal with a difficulty | *The state must (grapple with / tackle) rising debt and extricate itself from bad contracts.* |
| **Hurdle, Setback** | noun | a problem that blocks or delays progress | *The verdict is a major (hurdle / setback) for the project.* |
| **Jettison** | verb | to throw away or abandon something | *The party jettisoned the proposal after the backlash.* |
| **Reprieve, Respite** | noun | a short break or relief from trouble | *The rain brought a brief (reprieve / respite) from the heat.* |

## 🧠 Thinking, Reasoning & Memory ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cite, Warrant, Simulation** | verb | to give as a reason or justify it; *simulation* is a noun = a modelled run used to predict behaviour | *Officials (cite) new data that (warrants) a review, backed by a computer (simulation).* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **flect/flex, flu/flux, ject, spec/spect** | root | Latin roots: flect/flex = bend, flu/flux = flow, ject = throw, spec/spect = see or look | *(flect/flex) gives reflect, flexible; (flu/flux) gives fluent, influx; (ject) gives reject, eject; (spec/spect) gives inspect, spectator.* |
| **Mull, Deliberate, Reckon, Infer, Discern, Anticipation, Experience** | verb | to think, work out or perceive; *deliberate* also = done on purpose (adj.), *anticipation / experience* are nouns for expecting and for what you have lived through | *The board will (mull / deliberate) the plan and (reckon) the cost; from the data you can (infer / discern) a trend; (anticipation) ran high, and (experience) shaped the verdict.* |
| **Surmise, Postulate, Extrapolate, Speculation, Speculative, Hypothesis, Projection, Derive, Dwell, Synthesis, Reminiscent, Epistemic, Consciousness, Intelligence** | verb/noun | to work something out, guess it from clues, or turn it over in the mind. | *Analysts (surmise / postulate / extrapolate) from thin data; the (hypothesis / projection / speculation) is speculative at best, though it derives from real evidence; he dwelt on it for weeks before offering a synthesis.* |

## ⚖️ Fairness, Honesty & Truth ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Candid, Forthright, Veracious** | adjective | honest, direct and truthful in what one says | *She gave a (candid / forthright / veracious) account of the failures.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Credible, Tenable, Evidence, Fidelity, Exculpate, Exoneration, Unanimous** | adjective/noun | believable, defensible or backed by proof; also being cleared of blame. | *The claim is (credible / tenable) and the evidence supports it; his fidelity to the facts was total, the inquiry exculpated him, and the exoneration was unanimous.* |
| **Devout** | adjective | deeply religious or sincerely committed | *He was a devout follower of the movement.* |
| **Equitable** | adjective | fair and just to all | *The panel urged a more equitable sharing of river water.* |
| **Hindsight** | noun | understanding a situation only after it has happened | *In hindsight, the warning signs were obvious.* |
| **Lenient, Forbearance** | adjective/noun | not strict; patient and self-controlled in the face of provocation | *The judge was lenient; the state showed unusual forbearance.* |
| **Mitigation** | noun | action taken to make a problem less serious | *Flood mitigation works were funded this year.* |
| **Partisan, Divisive** | adjective | one-sided and splitting people into hostile camps | *The bill was (partisan / divisive) from the start.* |
| **Redress, Rectify** | verb/noun | to correct or set right a wrong | *The tribunal exists to (redress / rectify) such grievances.* |
| **Repatriate** | verb | to send someone back to their own country | *Hundreds of workers were repatriated after the war.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Rescind** | verb | to cancel or take back an order or decision | *The ministry rescinded the circular within a week.* |
| **Sanctimonious, Histrionic, Grandiose** | adjective | putting on a false show - of moral superiority, of emotion, or of grandeur | *The speech was (sanctimonious / histrionic / grandiose) and short on detail.* |
| **Veracity** | noun | truthfulness; accuracy (root VER = truth) | *The court questioned the veracity of the affidavit.* |

## Hostility, Bitterness & Stubbornness ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Animosity, Acrimony, Rancour** | noun | strong bitter hostility and resentment between people | *The talks collapsed amid (animosity / acrimony / rancour).* |
| **Dissolute, Licentious** | adjective | behaving without moral restraint | *The court described his (dissolute / licentious) conduct.* |
| **Forge** | verb | to build or create a bond; or, in the other sense, to fake a document | *The two states forged a water-sharing pact; he was jailed for forging signatures.* |
| **Hostile, Inimical, Virulent, Vituperative** | adjective | showing strong enmity or doing active harm; *vituperative* = bitterly abusive in words | *The climate was (hostile / inimical) to investment; his (virulent / vituperative) attacks drew censure.* |
| **Indelible** | adjective | impossible to remove or erase | *The riots left an indelible mark on the city.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Labyrinthine** | adjective | extremely complicated and confusing, like a maze | *The subsidy rules are labyrinthine.* |
| **Recalcitrant, Implacable** | adjective | stubbornly refusing to obey or to be calmed | *The (recalcitrant / implacable) faction blocked every compromise.* |

## 👑 Power, Control & Influence ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Clout, Hegemony, Wield, Capacity, Propensity** | noun | power or influence and the ability to use it; *wield* is a verb = to hold and use power, *propensity* = a natural tendency | *A bloc with real (clout) exercises (hegemony) and (wields) it freely, given the (capacity) to act and a (propensity) to intervene.* |
| **Interlocutor, Palliative, Tariff** | noun | instruments or roles used to manage a situation; *palliative* = a stop-gap that relieves but does not cure | *An (interlocutor) was appointed; the relief package was a mere (palliative), and the (tariff) stayed in place.* |

## 😀 Hope, Calm & Positivity ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Ameliorate** | verb | to make a bad situation better | *The grant helped ameliorate rural distress.* |
| **Assuage, Mollify, Placate** | verb | to calm or soothe someone who is angry or upset | *The package was meant to (assuage /* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *mollify / placate) the protesters.* |
| **Buoyant, Jubilant, Jovial, Genial** | adjective | cheerful and in high spirits; *buoyant* also = economically strong | *The crowd was (jubilant / jovial); the host was genial and markets stayed buoyant.* |
| **Impressive** | adjective | Making, or tending to make, a positive impression | *On the Grand Road of Puri The Jagannatha temple in the city in Odisha is an impressive place of worship, and the grand festival of the deity is incomparable* |
| **Phlegmatic, Nonchalant** | adjective | calm and unbothered, showing little emotion or concern | *He remained (phlegmatic / nonchalant) through the crisis.* |
| **Quixotic** | adjective | unrealistic and impractical in a hopeful, idealistic way | *It was a quixotic bid for the presidency.* |

## 🌑 Bad, Harmful & Unpleasant ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Adverse, Detrimental, Deleterious, Noxious, Baleful, Ominous, Grim, Harrowing, Lachrymose** | adjective | harmful, threatening or deeply unpleasant; *noxious* = poisonous, *ominous / baleful* = warning of coming evil, *lachrymose* = tearful | *(Adverse / detrimental / deleterious / noxious) fumes filled the street; the (baleful / ominous / grim) forecast made for a (harrowing), (lachrymose) night.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Cacophony, Embarrassments** | noun | an unpleasant clash of sound, or acute discomfort | *A (cacophony) of horns drowned the speech, adding to the government's (embarrassments).* |
| **Draconian, Stark, Incendiary, Wanton, Galvanic** | adjective | extremely harsh, blunt or inflaming | *The (draconian) order and its (stark) wording were (incendiary); (wanton) destruction followed, with a (galvanic) effect on protesters.* |
| **Endemic, Subprime, Ineffective** | adjective | a settled or low-grade bad condition; *endemic* = always present in a place or group, *subprime* = high-risk and poor quality | *Corruption is (endemic) here; (subprime) lending and (ineffective) oversight caused the crash.* |
| **Futile** | adjective | useless because it cannot work | *Further talks would be futile.* |
| **Insidious, Insidiously, Pernicious, Malignant, Malevolent, Vindictive, Machinations** | adjective | harmful in a hidden, spiteful or scheming way; *insidiously* is the adverb, *machinations* a noun = secret harmful plotting | *(Insidious / pernicious / malignant) rumours spread (insidiously); (malevolent / vindictive) rivals and their (machinations) did the rest.* |
| **mal-** | prefix | prefix meaning 'bad' or 'badly' | *(mal-) gives malfunction, malnutrition, maltreat.* |
| **Negligence, Impunity, Contaminate, Inadvertent, Inappropriate,** | noun/adjective/verb | failing in a duty, or acting in a way that damages, pollutes or offends. | *The (negligence / impunity) was inexcusable; officials contaminated the site, acted (inadvertently /* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Unacceptable, Unacknowledged, Profane** | | | *inappropriately), and used profane, unacceptable language that went unacknowledged.* |
| **Squalid, Putrid, Macabre, Brittle, Desiccation, Malnutrition** | adjective/noun | filthy, rotting, brittle or grimly unpleasant. | *Families live in (squalid / putrid) conditions; the macabre scene shocked inspectors; the brittle pipes and desiccation of the soil worsened malnutrition.* |

## 📦 Amount, Size & Plenty ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Abound** | verb | to exist in large numbers; to be plentiful | *Rumours abound about a cabinet reshuffle.* |
| **Abundant, Ample, Copious, Profuse** | adjective | existing in large, more-than-enough quantities | *The region has (abundant / ample / copious / profuse) rainfall.* |
| **Affordability** | noun | extent to which something is affordable, as measured by its cost relative to the amount that the purchaser is able to pay | *First-time home buyers are feeling the squeeze of higher interest rates with mortgage affordability at its worst level for 16 years.* |
| **Avarice** | noun | extreme greed for wealth | *Corporate avarice drove the collapse.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Average, Approximate** | noun/adjective | the typical middle value; close to but not exactly correct | *The average yield was about four tonnes, an approximate figure at best.* |
| **Concise, Laconic** | adjective | using very few words; short and clear | *His reply was (concise / laconic).* |
| **Dearth, Paucity** | noun | a serious shortage or very small amount of something | *There is a (dearth / paucity) of reliable district-level data.* |
| **Decimate** | verb | to destroy a large part of something; stronger than *reduce* | *The drought decimated the cattle herd.* |
| **Deficient, Meagre, Marginal** | adjective | not enough; very small in amount | *The diet was (deficient / meagre); the gains were marginal.* |
| **Exorbitant, Hefty** | adjective | far too high or large in price, amount or weight | *Patients were charged (exorbitant / hefty) fees.* |
| **Extraordinary, Existential, Evacuation, Ammunition** | adjective/noun | how far something reaches, or how far outside the ordinary it falls. | *The response was (extraordinary / existential) in scale; the evacuation used all the ammunition and manpower available.* |
| **Panacea** | noun | a supposed cure for all problems (usually said it is NOT one) | *Technology is no panacea for rural poverty.* |
| **Plethora, Surfeit, Myriad** | noun | a very large number or an excess of something | *The scheme drew a (plethora / surfeit / myriad) of complaints.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Stifle** | verb | to stop something from developing or being expressed | *The law stifles dissent.* |
| **Substantial** | adjective | large in size or amount | *A substantial share of the budget went unspent.* |
| **Superfluous, Redundant** | adjective | more than is needed; unnecessary | *The clause was (superfluous / redundant) and was dropped.* |
| **Surplus** | noun | the extra amount left when income is more than spending | *The state recorded a revenue surplus this year.* |
| **Unbridled, Unfettered** | adjective | not controlled or held back; without limits | *(Unbridled / Unfettered) construction choked the wetland.* |

## □ Difference, Comparison & Opposite ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Antithesis, Converse** | noun | the exact opposite of something | *His conduct is the (antithesis / converse) of everything the office stands for.* |
| **Difference** | noun | the quality of being unlike; a disparity | *The difference between the two states is stark.* |
| **Dwarf** | verb | to make something else look small by comparison | *The new plant dwarfs every rival in the region.* |

## Catch, Hold & Seize ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **cap/cept, ten/tain, duc/duct, fract/frag, de-, vac** | root | word roots and prefixes that build many editorial words | *cap/cept = take (capture, accept); ten/tain = hold (retain, contain); duc/duct = lead (conduct, induce); fract/frag = break (fracture, fragment); de- = down or remove (decrease, devalue); vac = empty (vacant, evacuate).* |
| **Nab** | verb | to catch or arrest someone | *Police nabbed the suspect at the airport.* |

## Cause, Effect & Consequence ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Adjacent, Contiguous, Contingent, Dependence, Implication, Comprise, Factor in, Correspondents, Alternative, Circumstances, Considerations, Considerable, Stakeholder, Manifold** | adjective/noun | lying next to, linked with, or relying on something else. | *The two plots are (adjacent / contiguous); the payout is contingent on audit, the dependence on imports is total, and every implication must be factored in.* |
| **Administered** NEW | verb | cause to ingest , either by openly | *The other half is provided and administered by* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | offering or through deceit | *limited-profit housing associations – an Austrian version of social housing providers that are permitted to make a small profit to finance their operations.* |
| **Aftermath, Fallout, Outcome, Ramification, Repercussion, Corollary** | noun | what follows from an event; *corollary* = something that logically follows, *repercussion / fallout* = the indirect bad after-effects | *In the (aftermath), the (fallout / repercussions / ramifications) were severe; the (outcome) was a natural (corollary) of the decision.* |
| **Allegiance** | noun | Loyalty to some cause, nation or ruler | *Now it shows how flimsy that allegiance is It's the World Cup final , so you pick a side.* |
| **Consequential** | adjective | Following as a result | *The most consequential fixture in international sport was, as it turned out, little more than a grand cosplay for the New Jersey leisure market.* |
| **Engender, Breed, Inflict, Wreak, Attribute, Causation, Factor** | verb | to cause or produce something, or to name the cause; *causation / factor* are nouns = the causal link and a contributing cause | *Delay (engenders / breeds) anger and (inflicts / wreaks) real damage; analysts (attribute) this to one (factor), though (causation) is unproven.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hinge, Entail, Offset** | verb | to depend on, require, or balance out | *Success (hinges) on funding, which (entails) new taxes; savings elsewhere (offset) the cost.* |

## ▲ Highest & Lowest Points ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Nadir** | noun | the lowest or worst point | *Relations between the two countries hit their nadir that year.* |
| **Zenith, Heyday, Culminate** | noun/verb | the highest or most successful point | *The party was at its (zenith / heyday) in 1984; the protests culminated in a march on the capital.* |

## 🗨 Talkative, Loud & Wordy ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bombastic, Grandiloquent, Turgid, Florid** | adjective | high-sounding, inflated and empty in language | *The speech was (bombastic / grandiloquent / turgid / florid) but said nothing new.* |
| **Garrulous, Loquacious** | adjective | talking far too much | *A (garrulous / loquacious) witness held up the hearing.* |

## Boldness, Recklessness & Daring ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Audacious, Intrepid** | adjective | very bold and fearless, sometimes shockingly so | *It was an (audacious / intrepid) rescue attempt.* |
| **Impetuous, Headlong** | adjective/adverb | acting fast without thinking; rushing in recklessly | *The impetuous decision was made headlong, without consulting anyone.* |

## 😨 Shyness, Caution & Restraint ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Astute, Perspicacious** | adjective | clever and shrewd, with sharp insight | *It was an (astute / perspicacious) reading of the market.* |
| **Diffident, Reticent, Reluctant, Circumspect** | adjective | holding back - through shyness, unwillingness, or careful caution | *He was (diffident / reticent / reluctant) about speaking; the ministry stayed circumspect on the figures.* |
| **Keen** | adjective | eager, or sharply aware and perceptive | *She was keen to start, and had a keen eye for detail.* |
| **Taciturn** | adjective | habitually saying very little | *The taciturn official gave one-word answers.* |

## □ Unity, Sameness & Division ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Consecutive** | noun | sequence of notes or chords that results | *US renews strikes on Iran as Trump* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | from repeated shifts in pitch of the same interval | *threatens to attack underground nuclear site The US president's threat to target a key Iranian nuclear site came ahead of the 11th consecutive night of attacks.* |
| **Homogeneous, Concurrent, Discrete** | adjective | alike, simultaneous, or separately distinct | *The sample was homogeneous; the two trials were concurrent; the syllabus is split into discrete units.* |
| **Juxtapose** | verb | to place things side by side for comparison | *The film juxtaposes rural poverty with urban excess.* |

## 🌟 Quality, Character & Behaviour ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Accidentally, Unintentionally** | adverb | without meaning to | *The file was (accidentally / unintentionally) deleted.* |
| **Administrations** | noun | act of administering | *Heads of devolved administrations are also adept at claiming credit when things go well and, when they go badly, diverting the blame on to national government.* |
| **Affable, Amiable, Cordial, Gregarious,** | adjective | pleasant, warm and easy to get on with. Suave and urbane | *The host was (affable / amiable / cordial / gregarious); his (suave* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Suave, Urbane, Amity** | | add smooth social polish; gregarious = fond of company. | */ urbane) manner put everyone at ease.* |
| **Authentic, bona fide** | adjective | genuine and real, not fake | *The manuscript is (authentic / bona fide).* |
| **Brusque** | adjective | abrupt and rude in manner | *His brusque reply ended the meeting.* |
| **Coherent, Comprehensive, Germane, Pertinent** | adjective | clear, complete and to the point | *We need a (coherent / comprehensive) policy; only (germane / pertinent) evidence was admitted.* |
| **Controversially, Horrendously, Excruciatingly, Architecturally** | adverb | adverbs of manner formed from common editorial adjectives | *Controversially, the bench went further; the scheme was horrendously mismanaged; progress was excruciatingly slow; architecturally, the building is a landmark.* |
| **Environmentally** | adverb | In a manner affecting the environment | *Buried questions: On the Sikkim tunnel accident The costs of projects in environmentally fragile zones are many* |
| **Fastidious, Pedantic, Pernickety** | adjective | overly concerned with small details, rules or standards. | *His (fastidious / pedantic / pernickety) checking slowed the whole process.* |
| **Haughty, Supercilious, Imperious,** | adjective | behaving as if better than everyone else, or plainly ill-mannered. | *The minister's (haughty / supercilious /* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Pompous, Pretentious, Insolent, Churlish, Obstreperous, Gauche** | | | *imperious / pompous / pretentious) reply angered the house; his (insolent / churlish / obstreperous) aide was worse, and the new recruit was merely gauche.* |
| **Historically** | adverb | In a historic manner | *The country's historically mild climate allowed developers to build houses without insulation, while industrialisation supplied plentiful coal to burn when temperatures dropped.* |
| **Illusory, Ostensible, Elusive** | adjective | not what it appears to be, or hard to pin down | *The gains proved (illusory / ostensible); a lasting settlement remains elusive.* |
| **Immaculate, Exemplary, Paragon, Incomparable** | noun/adjective | faultless; a perfect model of excellence | *His record is (immaculate / exemplary); she is a paragon of public service and, in her field, incomparable.* |
| **Importance, Endorsement** | noun | worth or note, and public backing | *The court stressed the importance of the right; the campaign won a celebrity endorsement.* |
| **Improvisational** | adjective | Having the nature of an improvisation | *A Soviet-schooled military officer deeply embedded within institutions tussled with a young civilian* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *disruptor taking a more agile, improvisational approach.* |
| **Irresponsibility** | noun | the state of not being answerable for one's actions | *The report blamed official irresponsibility for the lapse.* |
| **Legitimacy, de jure** | noun/adjective | rightful and lawful standing | *The government's legitimacy was questioned; de jure the office is elected, in practice it is not.* |
| **Neighbourhood** | noun | quality of being a neighbor, of living nearby, next to each-other | *Across the capital, there were 35,000 fewer "neighbourhood crimes" – a category which includes burglaries, thefts, robberies and vehicle crime offences – in the past 12 months than in the year before.* |
| **Possibilities** | noun | quality of being possible | *Many people are enjoying healthier, richer lives for longer, and redefining the meaning and possibilities of old age.* |
| **Pulchritude, Mellifluous, Euphony, Embellish, Entertainment, Performance** | noun/adjective/verb | physically beautiful, sweet to the ear, or made more attractive. | *Her (pulchritude / mellifluous voice) drew crowds; the euphony of the hall was perfect, the stage was embellished, and the entertainment and performance were flawless.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Pusillanimous** | adjective | cowardly and lacking courage | *The pusillanimous response emboldened the attackers.* |
| **Sanitation, Eligibility** | noun | public-service terms: waste management, and the right to qualify | *Sanitation coverage rose sharply; eligibility for the scheme was widened.* |

## Other & Mixed ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Acceptable** | adjective | Worthy, decent, sure of being accepted or received with at least moderate pleasure | *We need to find an acceptable present for Jeff.* |
| **Accountable** | adjective | Obliged, when called upon, to answer | *The Grim Lessons of Israel's War in Gaza Israel has not been held accountable for its actions in Gaza.* |
| **Acknowledgments** NEW | noun | act of acknowledging | *Conservatives who critique land acknowledgments aren't acting in good faith, but they do have a point.* |
| **Announcements** | noun | act of announcing, or giving notice | *If Mr Burnham agrees, he will have to wait before making any big announcements.* |
| **Apocalyptic** | noun | One who predicts apocalypse | *Given the somewhat apocalyptic conditions, getting dressed to go to the office is the last thing* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *anyone wants to think about, mainly because it feels wrong to be working.* |
| **Artificial** NEW | adjective | Man-made | *Race Open-weight models have been the underlying strength of Chinese artificial intelligence strategy.* |
| **Astonishment** | noun | feeling or experience of being astonished | *But in this role, to general astonishment, he placed the public good above special interests.* |
| **Civilization** | noun | organized culture encompassing many communities, often on the scale of a nation or a people | *Three speeches on a single day signaled a dying American democracy \| Robert Shpiner Stephen Miller warned of a leftwing 'cancer' threatening civilization.* |
| **Commercial** | noun | advertisement in a common media format, usually radio or television | *The last time America hosted, the problem wasn't commercial overkill so much as sheer shrugging apathy.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Complications** | noun | act or process of complicating | *Teen jailed for exam cheating in Guinea dies after sickle cell complications, father says Mamadou Djouma Bah, 17, was arrested and sentenced to prison for exam fraud earlier this month.* |
| **Consideration** | noun | thought process of considering, of taking multiple or specified factors into account | *After much consideration, I have decided to stay.* |
| **Contradiction** | noun | act of contradicting | *The apparent contradiction – fortifying the centre to pursue an agenda of decentralisation – arises from a perversity in the way the British state works or, rather, fails to work* . |
| **Decentralisation** | noun | action of decentralizing, or the state of being decentralized | *The apparent contradiction – fortifying the centre to pursue an agenda of decentralisation – arises from a perversity in the way the British state works or, rather, fails to work* . |
| **Demonstrations** NEW | noun | act of demonstrating | *Students and others have continued their demonstrations* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *despite allegations of state excesses.* |
| **Destabilize** | verb | make something unstable | *Haiti Needs Stability, Not Mass Deportations Deporting Haitian migrants will further destabilize a country in crisis.* |
| **Devolution** | noun | rolling down | *But genuine control, especially when it comes to fiscal policy, has not matched the rhetoric of devolution.* |
| **Distraction** NEW | noun | Something that distracts | *Poking one's eye is a good distraction from a hurting toe.* |
| **Distribution** | noun | act of distributing or state of being distributed | *Lists of folly: On the Supreme Court, the SIR and benefits A flawed SIR should not be the basis for distribution of benefits* |
| **Educational** NEW | noun | free trip for travel consultants, provided by a travel operator or airline as a means of promoting their service | *India cockroach protests: Videos show officers firing 'pellet guns' Thousands of people have taken to the streets in Delhi as part of the cockroach protests, calling for educational reforms.* |
| **Environment** | noun | surroundings of, and influences on, a particular item of interest | *There's a slightly mean question I often ask British people with an interest in the living world: can you* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *name the environment secretary?* |
| **Exhibition** NEW | noun | instance of exhibiting, or something exhibited | *Ten killed in Russian attack on drone exhibition near Kyiv The event, attended by prominent members of the Ukrainian defence industry, was hit by ballistic missiles in the middle of the day.* |
| **Exploitation** | noun | act of utilizing something | *Through the VRU, we've done just that, providing interventions and positive opportunities to prevent more than half a million young people from getting caught up in a vicious cycle of violence and exploitation.* |
| **Facilitating** | verb | make easy or easier | *But rather than stop it, the government has been facilitating it.* |
| **Homelessness** | noun | state of being homeless | *But I wasn't in the space of wanting to play semantics with it." Daniel Lavelle writes on mental health, homelessness and social care.* |
| **Impossible** | noun | impossibility | *An article in the Observer concluded that Vienna shows "decent homes for all"* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *is not an impossible dream.* |
| **Improbable** | adjective | Not likely to be true | *The garish half-time show curated by Chris Martin of Coldplay seemed to reinforce that – but then came a moment of improbable genius.* |
| **Incongruities** | noun | state of being incongruous, or lacking congruence | *The MetLife Stadium on Sunday night was a melting pot of colliding incongruities and temporary identities.* |
| **Independent** | noun | candidate or voter not affiliated with any political party, a freethinker, free of a party platform | *Diana Berg is a Ukrainian artist, writer and cultural manager from Mariupol, and the founder of Platform TU, an independent cultural initiative now operating in exile after Russia's full-scale invasion.* |
| **Initiative** | noun | beginning | *Battling drug abuse: On Kerala's Operation Toofan Kerala has shown initiative in coordinated action against cartels* |
| **Inspiration** | noun | drawing of air into the lungs, accomplished in mammals by elevation of the chest walls and flattening of | *Fast fashion and mall brands used to look to the runways for inspiration.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | the diaphragm, as part of the act o | |
| **Installation** | noun | act of installing | *My street now resembles an art installation, with varying colours and patterns of bed sheets taped to windows in the battle against the heat.* |
| **Institutions** | noun | custom or practice of a society or community | *A Soviet-schooled military officer deeply embedded within institutions tussled with a young civilian disruptor taking a more agile, improvisational approach.* |
| **Insulation** | noun | act of insulating | *The country's historically mild climate allowed developers to build houses without insulation, while industrialisation supplied plentiful coal to burn when temperatures dropped.* |
| **Intellectuals** | noun | intelligent, learned person, especially one who discourses about learned matters | *In the early 20th century, Chinese intellectuals sought to capture the harsh realities of working-class lives.* |
| **Intergenerational** | adjective | Between or across generations | *But the statistics and direction of travel also point to immense* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *social challenges, with implications for the way we work, intergenerational fairness and the future funding of care.* |
| **Interventions** | noun | action of intervening | *Through the VRU, we've done just that, providing interventions and positive opportunities to prevent more than half a million young people from getting caught up in a vicious cycle of violence and exploitation.* |
| **Investment** | noun | act of investing, or state of being invested | *The CETA can reshape trade and investment flows, create quality jobs and growth, and transition India to a more competitive and innovation-driven economy* |
| **Journalist** | noun | keeper of a personal journal, who writes in it regularly | *María Ramírez is a journalist and deputy managing editor of elDiario.es, a news outlet in Spain Do you have an opinion on the issues raised in this article?* |
| **Opportunistic** | adjective | Taking advantage of situations that arise | *Ghanaians' ICC petition over migrant attacks 'opportunistic', says South Africa The petition argues the* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| | | | *violence against migrants in South Africa could amount to crimes against humanity.* |
| **Pessimistic** NEW | adjective | Marked by pessimism and little hopefulness | *So many British people have it better than they think – it's up to Burnham to make them see that \| Polly Toynbee A new survey suggests voters are becoming more cynical and pessimistic.* |
| **Photographing** | verb | take a photograph of | *On a crowded train of people mostly staring obliviously at our own phones, a stranger had been covertly photographing that little girl over and over again.* |
| **Preference** | noun | selection of one thing or person over others | *Yet Burnham's support for the government's suffocating fiscal rules – and his preference for the vaguer language of "public control" over public ownership – had already raised doubts about how far he was prepared to go.* |
| **Presumption** | noun | act of presuming, or something presumed | *As a critical care doctor, I have a response to his diagnosis The* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | *presumption that US elections are legitimate died last week in Washington.* |
| **Progressives** | noun | person who actively favors or strives for progress towards improved conditions, as in society or government | *That a self-described leftwing party could have such success by fixing on Mexico's chasmic inequality has drawn attention from hopeful progressives worldwide.* |
| **Prominence** | noun | state of being prominent | *Reforms in recent years have created institutions with varying degrees of local autonomy – elected mayoralties like the one in Manchester that afforded Mr Burnham a platform for national prominence.* |
| **Pronouncements** | noun | official public announcement | *Following her latest pronouncements, Badenoch has effectively committed the Conservatives to a policy of conflict, and possibly even rupture, with the EU.* |
| **Punishment** | noun | act or process of punishing, imposing and/or applying a sanction | *Voters reserve the greatest punishment for the politicians they think acted too little, or too late, to prevent them getting poorer.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Questionable** | adjective | Problematic | *That was always a questionable assertion, given the defining postwar role of Labour in shaping a fairer social settlement.* |
| **Reproductive** | noun | reproductive organism | *That this was the final straw for his party revealed how, in the conservative Germany of today, reproductive politics can mark a red line.* |
| **Significance** | noun | extent to which something matters | *Social care has personal significance for Mr Burnham.* |
| **Strategist** NEW | noun | Someone who devises strategies | *Katz, the political strategist behind candidates like Zohran Mamdani, John Fetterman and Graham Platner, makes the case for the party to embrace a more populist platform on "The Ezra Klein Show."* |
| **Traditional** | noun | person with traditional beliefs | *"I wasn't making what you would call a traditional target," the mayor said.* |
| **Uninhabitable** | adjective | Not fit for people to live in | *The earthquake left many homes in the area uninhabitable.* |

## 🧬 Word Roots, Prefixes & Latin Phrases ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **a priori, de facto, per capita, inter alia, nota bene, prima facie, pro rata, status quo, vice versa, vis-a-vis, ad hoc** | phrase | Set Latin and formal expressions common in editorial, legal and economic writing. | *A priori reasoning needs no data; a de facto ruler holds power without the title; income is compared per capita; the report lists, inter alia, three reforms; nota bene, the deadline is fixed; funds are shared pro rata; prima facie the case stands; the status quo remains; vis-a-vis last year growth is slower, and vice versa applies too; the panel was set up on an ad hoc basis.* |
| **bene, bene-** | prefix | bene and bene- mean 'good' or 'well'. | *The root (bene / bene-) gives benefit, benefactor and benevolent.* |
| **bio, vita/viv, nat, gen, carn, anthrop, mort, geo, hydro, therm, photo, path** | root | Greek/Latin roots about living things and the natural world: bio & vita/viv = life, nat = born, gen = birth or race, carn = flesh, anthrop = human, mort = death, geo = earth, hydro = water, therm = heat, photo = light, path = feeling or disease. | *Roots unlock new words: (bio) gives biology, (geo) gives geography, (mort) gives mortality.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **mono, bi, tri, semi-, multi, poly, omni, max, min, over-, under-, equ** | prefix | Prefixes showing how many or how much: mono = one, bi = two, tri = three, semi- = half, multi/poly = many, omni = all, max = greatest, min = small or less, over- = too much, under- = too little, equ = equal. | *Add the prefix (mono / bi / tri) to get monorail, bicycle and triangle.* |
| **port, fer, tract, mit/miss, vert/vers, pos/pon, rupt, scrib/script, graph/gram** | root | Roots about carrying, moving, writing and breaking: port, fer and tract = carry or pull, mit/miss = send, vert/vers = turn, pos/pon = place or put, rupt = break, scrib/script and graph/gram = write or draw. | *The root (port / fer / tract) gives transport, transfer and tractor.* |
| **pre-, fore-, post-, ex-, sub-, inter-, intra-, trans-, tele** | prefix | Prefixes showing position or time: pre- and fore- = before or front, post- = after, ex- = out or former, sub- = under or below, inter- = between, intra- = within, trans- = across, tele = far. | *The prefix (pre- / post- / trans-) fixes time or direction: preview, postwar, transport.* |
| **psych, cogn, sci, fid, sens/sent, aud, vid/vis, phon, doc, phil, am/amor, chron, chrono, ann/enn, auto** | root | Roots about the mind, knowing, trusting and the senses: psych = mind, cogn & sci = know, fid = faith or trust, sens/sent = feel, aud | *The root (psych / cogn / vid-vis) appears in psychology, recognise and vision; (fid) gives fidelity, and (ann/enn) gives annual.* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | = hear, vid/vis = see, phon = sound, doc = teach, phil & am/amor = love, chron/chrono = time, ann/enn = year, auto = self. | |
| **un-, non-, in-/im-/il-/ir-, anti-** | prefix | Prefixes that reverse or oppose a meaning: un-, non- and in-/im-/il-/ir- all mean 'not'; anti- means 'against'. | *Put (un- / non- / in-im-il-ir-) before a word to negate it: unhappy, non-stop, impossible.* |

## 🏛 Polity, Government & Civics ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Conservative, Progressive, Revolutionary, Maverick, Iconoclast, Hegemon, Gerontocracy, Envoy, Geopolitical, International, Pariah** | noun/adjective | people and powers defined by their political stance or dominance. | *A (conservative / progressive / revolutionary) wing formed; the maverick iconoclast defied the hegemon, the gerontocracy sent an envoy, and the pariah state was frozen out of geopolitical talks.* |
| **Franchise, Suffrage, Electorate, Constituency, Plebiscite, Gerrymander, Delimitation, Registration, Representation, Representatives, Participation,** | noun/verb | the right to vote and the machinery of elections and representation. | *Every adult has the (franchise / suffrage); the electorate of each constituency voted in a plebiscite, though delimitation was gerrymandered; registration, participation and grassroots* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Grassroots, Mobilisation** | | | *mobilisation decide who the representatives are and how good the representation is.* |
| **Governance, Legislation, Regulation, Constitution, Constitutional, Unconstitutional, Parliament, Parliamentary, Polity, Jurisprudence, Impeachment, Prosecution, Enforcement, Administrative, Institutional, Institutionalised, Establishment, Inspectorate, Presidential, Tenet** | noun/adjective | the bodies, rules, offices and processes by which a state is run. | *Good (governance / legislation / regulation) rests on the constitution; parliament debates it, the polity accepts it, and jurisprudence interprets it; impeachment, prosecution and enforcement follow when constitutional limits are broken.* |
| **Nationalism, Xenophobia, Antisemitism, Diaspora, Asylum, Immigration, Indigenous, Civilisation, Radicalization, Partisanship, Ideological** | noun/adjective | ideas about who belongs to a nation, who is kept out, and who leads it. | *Rising (nationalism / xenophobia / antisemitism) hardened attitudes; the diaspora sought asylum, immigration dominated debate, and indigenous claims were ignored as radicalization and partisanship grew.* |

## 🔗 Science, Work & Industry ↑ top

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Construction, Development, Innovation, Installations, Automation, Connectivity, Shipbuilding, Reindustrialised, Foundation, Infrastructure, Acquisition, Deploy, Recruitment, Transformation, Transformative, Framework, Semiconductor, Cybersecurity, Irrigation, Agricultural** | noun/verb | creating, installing or expanding physical and industrial capacity. | *The (construction / development / innovation) drive rebuilt the region; new installations and automation improved connectivity, the yard resumed shipbuilding, and the area was reindustrialised on a firm foundation of infrastructure.* |
| **Professional, Professionals, Occupation, Occupational, Apprenticeship, Apprenticeships, Manufacturers, Attendance, Reputation, Conventional, Individual, Adolescent, Responsibility, Responsible, Recognition** | noun/adjective | jobs, the people who do them, and the training that leads to them. | *The (professional / professionals) in each occupation trained through an (apprenticeship / apprenticeships); manufacturers reported strong attendance, and the occupational standard protected their reputation.* |
| **Scientific, Computational, Algorithmic, Technological, Neuroscience,** | adjective/noun | branches of study and the language of science and technology. | *The (scientific / computational / algorithmic / technological) work spanned neuroscience,* |

| Words | Part of Speech | Meaning | Example |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Anthropology, University, Mythological, Testosterone, Masculinity, Breastfeeding, Environmental, Environmentalist** | | | *anthropology and mythological studies at the university.* |

**Days merged:** 29 (2026-06-25, 2026-06-26, 2026-06-27, 2026-06-28, 2026-06-29, 2026-06-30, 2026-07-01, 2026-07-02, 2026-07-04, 2026-07-05, 2026-07-06, 2026-07-07, 2026-07-08, 2026-07-09, 2026-07-10, 2026-07-11, 2026-07-12, 2026-07-13, 2026-07-14, 2026-07-15, 2026-07-16, 2026-07-17, 2026-07-19, 2026-07-20, 2026-07-21, 2026-07-22, 2026-07-23, 2026-07-24, 2026-07-25)
**Sources:** Curated word bank + mined editorial words, consolidated into meaning-families.